

SOP-44: Operator Onboarding and Certification

Version 1.0 · 2026-08-10 · First build, no predecessor · Owner: PPC Lead, intake by CEO · Thresholds live in the Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 only; this SOP carries zero local thresholds and issues zero closed-vocabulary keyword verdicts

1. Verdict and Scope

VERDICT: certification is an artifact, not an impression, and it is the gate between reading the system and deploying against the live account. This SOP owns the path a person walks from zero to scope: the reading order through the canon, the arithmetic gate, the instrument gate, the per-SOP comprehension check assembled from that SOP's Element 11, the three-checkpoint ramp at weeks 1, 2 and 4, the live defense, the certification record, its wiring into the PPC Authority Matrix v2.0, and its suspension and revocation. It owns one further gate the program has already written into its own definition of done: no agent skill enters production on a component until at least one human is certified on that component, because a skill reviewed by an uncertified human is an unreviewed skill. Certification grants scope. It never moves a human-confirmation line, and it never confers a threshold-setting right.

1.1 What certification is, stated as four separable claims

A certification record asserts four things and nothing else. First, the holder can locate every number the assigned SOP consumes without being told where it lives. Second, the holder executes that SOP's procedures such that the checkpoint holder changes no staged value on the final supervised cycle. Third, the holder can defend the reasoning behind the governing rules without reciting their values, because an operator who knows only values cannot extend the system to a case the rules have not met. Fourth, the holder routes every item that belongs to someone else, including every item in the permanent human-confirmed tier. The fourth claim is the one that fails most often and it is the one that ends a ramp rather than delaying it.

What a certification record does not assert: that the holder may set a threshold, that the holder may deploy an item in the human-confirmed tier without confirmation, or that the holder's scope extends past the assignment on the record. Scope for the incoming operator is set by the PPC Operations Transition Brief v1.2 stack, per PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 "Standing Rules", rule 4. This SOP records against that scope; it does not author it.

1.2 The permanent line certification does not move

Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 Section 12 "Layer 7: Precedence and Conflict Resolution (P1-P10)", rule P5, places every 500+ SV keyword action, every gate failure, every structural change, every bid move above 25%, every budget move above \$50 per day, and every LOW-confidence verdict in the human-confirmed tier. That tier is a property of the action, not of the operator, so no tenure and no certification level removes an item from it. v4.0 Section 11 "Layer 6: Transitions, Stages, Modes (T1-T8) and Recovery Mode (R1-R6)", rule R3, tightens the same tier inside Recovery Mode to every bid move above 15% and every budget move above \$25 per day. A certified operator who stops routing those items has failed the standard the certification was issued against, and P12 in this document is the response.

1.3 Boundaries with adjacent components

Adjacent component	The seam, stated so it is owned
Criteria System v4.0	Decides every threshold, band, scenario, verdict and human-review tier that a certification test examines. This SOP tests comprehension of those rules; it never sets one. A number in this SOP that is not traceable to v4.0 with its section heading is a defect.
#3 Authority Matrix v2.0	Owns who decides, executes, reviews and is informed, and owns the vacancy rule. Every competence in this SOP is one matrix row turned into a demonstration. The matrix is the destination of the certification record; it is not rewritten here.
#1 Operations Definition Register and Supersession Map	Owns component status and version numbering. The reading order in P2 is sequenced from register wave order; this SOP does not grade component status.
Each operating SOP, #06 and #12 through #46	Owns its own Element 11 ramp content. This SOP consumes that content and aggregates it; it never authors a competence for another component, because a competence written here rather than there would not survive that component's next rebuild.
#11 Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0	Owns the eight cases E1 to E8 and the standard training base. P3 administers them as a gate; the cases themselves and their values belong there.
#46 Access and Permissions	Owns provisioning, deprovisioning and the access register. This SOP sends a certification signal and a suspension signal; it never provisions a credential and never suspends one directly.
#06 V5 Prediction Scoring	Owns prediction scoring method and the four score values. This SOP reads the resulting per-owner series as post-certification evidence and grades no prediction itself.
#37 Automation rules and the skills program	Owns rule registration and skill conversion. This SOP owns only the human precondition on conversion: at least one certified operator on the component first.
#40 Monthly, quarterly and annual cadence	Owns the calendar that will carry the recertification ritual once built. Until it exists, P11 states its own cadence from named sources and hands the ritual over on #40's publication.
#45 Dayparting deferral	Authorizes zero hourly modifiers. No certification scope includes an hourly modifier, because the lever is dormant.

1.4 What this SOP cannot certify at v1.0, stated before it is discovered

The Cross-Reference Ledger row for component 44 states that this component consumes Element 11 from all 23 SOPs. One SOP has delivered one: PPC SOP-12 Exact Campaign Operations v2.1 Section 11 "Operator Ramp", whose own Section 11.6 and downstream contract I-24 name this component as the consumer and date the handoff to 2026-09-25. Every other operating SOP in the library carries no Element 11 today. The operational consequence is stated rather than engineered around: **at v1.0 this SOP can run one complete certification track, on component #12, and it opens a deferred track on every other component that reads DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11) until that component's ramp lands.** A comprehension check invented here for an SOP that has not written its own ramp would be a house-style test rather than a matrix-traceable one, and it could not be aggregated with the ramps that arrive later. P5 step 6 handles the deferral; F9 handles the pressure to skip it.

Length note per the Build Kit depth standard. The SOP Program Gap Register v1.0 estimated this component at 2 pages. That estimate was made against the superseded 10-element standard. At the 12-element standard the component carries 13 procedures, 11 failure modes, 3 worked examples, 24 interface contracts and a certification record schema, and it fills the 10-18 page target without padding. The Gap Register's page estimate is superseded for build purposes exactly as its depth table is.

2. Trigger Conditions

Lag column note: v4.0 contains no interface-lag or onboarding-lag threshold, so no maximum lag below is a v4.0 number. Each is a cadence fact from the named source, and a governing maximum lag is amendment item AM-2 in Section 12.4.

Trigger	Detecting artifact	Stated lag and its source	Procedure
Operator intake	A named scope assignment in the Transition Brief v1.2 stack, or a CEO intake decision per the Gap Register owner line for this component	Same day as the assignment is recorded (Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 rule 4 makes the brief the scope source, so the record opens when the scope exists)	P1 open the certification file
Ramp content arrives	An operating SOP publishes or amends its Element 11, visible as a Ledger row rewrite for that component	Before the next intake on that scope (Ledger Section 4 "The Accretion Rule": the row is the handoff, not the document)	P5 assemble or refresh the check; P11 step 4 re-test issued holders
Checkpoint due	Week 1, week 2 and week 4 dates on the open certification file	Recorded on the checkpoint date; a checkpoint recorded late is recorded with its true date, never back-dated	P6, P7, P8
Live defense due	All week 4 audit competences recorded, from P8	End of week 4 (SOP-12 v2.1 Section 11.5 sets the defense at the end of week 4 for the one delivered ramp)	P9 live defense
Skill conversion proposed	A skill file for component N enters the conversion queue	Before conversion begins, not before deployment (Gap Register Definition-of-Done addition 9)	P13 skills-conversion gate
Authority Matrix re-issue	A new Authority Matrix version, which re-issues within one week of any org change touching its roles (Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 rule 6)	Within the same week the matrix re-issues, because a moved letter moves a competence	P11 step 2 competence remap
v4.0 increment	A new Criteria System version, or a landed v4.1 amendment batch	Before the next live defense on any scope citing a changed rule	P11 step 3 defense-answer re-validation
Override or accuracy signal	Per-owner override entries in T6 Decision Log and per-owner V5 hit rate on Account Rollup A3 Verification scoreboard	Monthly, with the v4.0 Section 14 rule V2 override review; quarterly with rule V6 confidence calibration	P11 steps 5-6 standing review
Confirmed unconfirmed deployment	A P5-tier item deployed without its confirmation record, found in the #38 T+1 verification report or the cycle's T6 entries	Same day as the finding	P12 suspension, first branch
Role vacancy	A checkpoint holder role unfilled during an open ramp	Same day (Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 rule 5 reverts D to the PPC Lead and E to the PPC Manager)	P1 step 5 holder substitution; the ramp continues rather than pausing

3. Preconditions and Gates

Each gate below names the artifact that proves it passed. A gate with no observable is not a gate; it is an opinion, and this SOP records observables.

Gate	Manifest ID or source of record	Observable that proves it passed
Scope exists	Transition Brief v1.2 scope stack, per Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 rule 4	A named product or decision-class scope on the certification file header, with the assigning role recorded.
Ramp content exists	The target component's Element 11, cited by its Cross-Reference Ledger row rather than by its procedure number	The Ledger row for that component names an Element 11 in its Owns exclusively cell. Absent that, the track opens DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11) and P5 step 6 runs.
Matrix currency	PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 1 "The Matrix"	The matrix version on the certification file matches the current published version. A version mismatch re-runs P11 step 2 before any checkpoint is recorded.
Threshold pin	Criteria System v4.0, cited by section heading in every defense answer	The v4.0 version string on the certification file matches the version the defense answers were written against.
Arithmetic source	Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0, cases E1 to E8	The eight cases are available to the checkpoint holder in full. The set's own "Use and Governance" section makes cold reproduction the onboarding standard, so P3 administers what already exists.
Instrument access	PPC Command Workbook TEMPLATE v1.0, tabs T0 PRODUCT COMMAND through T7 MANIFEST plus REFERENCE, and the Account Rollup Workbook	The candidate can open the live product workbook for the assigned scope read-only, and the READ ME drill path is present.
Login rights reconcile	#46 access register	An access-register row exists for the candidate at the tier the ramp requires. Access without a certification track, or a track without access, is F7.
Packet readable	T7 MANIFEST columns "Catalog ID + Field Group", "Status" and "Verdict Classes Blocked While Missing", under v4.0 Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass", gate G8	The manifest renders with a status on every field group. A DEGRADED packet does not block the ramp; it changes what week 2 can be graded on, and the blocked verdict classes are written on the checkpoint record.
Scoring surface live	T6 DECISION LOG and Account Rollup A3 Verification scoreboard, per Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 Section 9 "The Infrastructure Tabs: Logs and the Manifest (T5-T7)" and Section 11 "The Account Rollup Workbook"	Per-owner rows resolve on A3 for the assigned scope. Absent that, P11 steps 5-6 record NO EVIDENCE AVAILABLE rather than a favourable read.
Vocabulary source pinned	Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0, sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	The verdict-string list used by the comprehension check is the one on that sheet, with the count recorded on the certification file. See the vocabulary-count finding in Section 12.4.

4. Step-Level Procedures

P1. Open the certification file and set the scope target · 25 minutes

1. Create the record per Appendix A. Header fields: candidate role, assigning role, scope statement, target component numbers, matrix version, v4.0 version, Ledger version, open date.
2. Read the scope statement out of the Transition Brief v1.2 stack and copy it verbatim. Where the brief names a scope this SOP would have worded differently, the brief wins and the difference is not reconciled here.
3. For each target component, read its Cross-Reference Ledger row and copy its Owns exclusively cell into the file. This is what the candidate will be certified against, and it is why a rebuilt component forces a re-test rather than a footnote.
4. Set the checkpoint holder per component from Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 1 "The Matrix": the holder is the D role on the rows the component executes.
5. Vacancy substitution: where a checkpoint holder role is unfilled, apply Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 rule 5 and record the substituted holder on the file. The ramp continues against the substitute. Recording the substitution matters because a competence signed by a role that did not exist is unauditable later.
6. Record the certification state as IN RAMP, or DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11) where P5 step 6 applies.

P2. The reading order pass · 3 to 5 working days, run inside week 1

The order is fixed and it is the order the Gap Register named for this component: the register, then the doctrine, then the Criteria System, then the SOPs in wave order. It runs governance before reasoning before rules before procedures, so that the candidate meets each threshold already knowing which layer owns it.

1. PPC Operations Definition Register v1.1 and the PPC A-to-Z System Map v0.9: what the components are and which layer answers which question. Output: the candidate names, in one line each, the five layers and what each owns.
2. PPC Strategic Doctrine v1.0, Section 1 "Verdict and First Principles" through the failure-pattern mapping: why the rules are what they are. Output: the candidate restates the five governing principles and names, for two of the account's known failure patterns, the doctrine clause that prevents each.
3. Criteria System v4.0, in stack order per its Section 2 "The Decision Stack: Eleven Layers From Raw Metric to Deployed Action". Gates before objectives before diagnosis before scenarios before levers before sizing. Output: the candidate lists the twelve gates from Section 5 and names, for three of them, the

action class the gate blocks.

4. Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 and the Command Workbook READ ME: where each number physically lives. Output: the drill path written from memory, T0 through T4, with T5 to T7 named as the memory tabs.
5. The assigned SOPs in wave order, each read against its Ledger row. Output: for each, the Owns exclusively cell restated in the candidate's own words and reconciled to the document.
6. Reading is recorded as done or not done per item. It carries no score, because reading is a precondition rather than a competence, and scoring it would create a number this SOP has no authority to set.

P3. The arithmetic gate · 90 minutes, closed book

1. Administer all eight cases E1 to E8 from the Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0 with the inputs changed and the structure held, which is the variation method that document's "Use and Governance" section already prescribes for the live-defense session.
2. The candidate computes, showing each step: the break-even chain from contribution and AOV; maximum profitable CPC; target CPC; cost per order and the loss line at a stated CVR; the push sizing chain from order gap to required clicks to required spend to duration to loss ceiling; the two-products-same-ACOS margin-class comparison; the CVR-adjusted cross-format comparison; the liquidation allowable-cost computation; and the TACOS identity.
3. Marking is per case, correct or not correct, against the arithmetic. No aggregate percentage is computed, because no pass mark exists to compare it against. See Section 12.4, AM-1.
4. A not-correct case repeats once in week 2 against a third variation. A case not correct on the second attempt is recorded NOT DEMONSTRATED and travels to P9, where the defense question for that case is asked cold.
5. The gate tests arithmetic, not recall of the training base. A candidate who reproduces the training base values but cannot recompute them from changed inputs has not demonstrated the case.

P4. The instrument gate · 2 hours, at the workbook

1. Open the assigned scope's product workbook. Walk T0 PRODUCT COMMAND zone by zone and state what each zone constrains below it.
2. Open T7 MANIFEST. List every field group reading MISSING or PARTIAL with the entry in the "Verdict Classes Blocked While Missing" column for each. A read that names fewer blocked classes than the manifest lists is returned, because the whole purpose of gate G8 is that analysis states what it could not see.
3. Open T2 KEYWORD COMMAND, apply the OVERSIGHT filter view, and expand one keyword to its campaign child rows. State which campaigns run against that term and what each one's spend share of the keyword is.
4. Open T6 DECISION LOG and list the rows whose Review Date lands in the current cycle. Score nothing.
5. Open the Account Rollup A1 Family Boards and name one shared head term with its declared owner, or state that the owner is undeclared, which is itself the readable state.
6. Record each of the five as demonstrated or not demonstrated with the artifact the candidate produced.

P5. Assemble the per-SOP comprehension check · 60 minutes per component

1. Open the target component's Element 11. Copy its competence rows without editing them. The check is that document's ramp, administered; it is not a check this SOP writes.
2. Copy its live-defense questions and their stated sources into the certification file's defense section.
3. Add the verdict-string items from Section 5 of this document that the component's own Element 5 mapping uses, quoted verbatim from the Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0 sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference".
4. Add the component's Ledger row boundary items as routing items: for each thing the component does not own, the candidate names the owning component number.
5. Record the check's provenance line: component number, document version, Element 11 section, Ledger version. A check whose provenance line is empty cannot be re-validated when the component rebuilds, and P11 step 4 depends on it.
6. **No Element 11 branch.** Where the target component has published no Element 11, do not write one. Record the track DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11), name the component and its Ledger due date, and open the deferral on the certification file. The candidate may still run P2, P3 and P4 for that scope, since those gates are component-independent, and may work the scope under the ordinary supervision the Authority Matrix already sets. What does not happen is a certification record asserting competence on a component whose competences have never been declared.

P6. Week 1 checkpoint: observation and artifact familiarity · recorded in 45 minutes

1. Nothing deploys under the candidate's name in week 1. This is a scope fact, not a courtesy: an unrecorded competence has no matrix row behind it.
2. Record the P2 reading outputs, the P3 case results and the P4 instrument reads.
3. Record each component-specific week 1 competence from the assembled check, with the evidence artifact and the reviewing role named per row.
4. A competence not demonstrated in week 1 repeats in week 2 alongside the week 2 work. It does not block the ramp and it does not disappear from the record.
5. Close week 1 when every competence carries a demonstrated or not-demonstrated mark. A blank is neither, and a blank closes nothing.

P7. Week 2 checkpoint: supervised execution · recorded in 45 minutes at week close

1. The candidate stages; the checkpoint holder reviews every staged row before it reaches the deployment path. The supervision is on the artifact, not on the person: the reviewer reads the staged row and its reason string.
2. Record the component-specific week 2 competences from the assembled check.
3. Record the refusal competence explicitly. At least one item in the week must be identified as needing a number that v4.0 does not carry, and routed as an amendment request instead of executed. A candidate who declines nothing in two weeks of live work has not demonstrated the refusal, and the

competence is marked not demonstrated rather than waived, because the refusal is the single behaviour that keeps thresholds in one place.

- Record the prediction competence: every change staged in the week carries metric, direction, magnitude, horizon and review date, per v4.0 Section 14 "Layer 9: Verification and Learning (V1-V8)", rule V1.
- Week 2 closes when the checkpoint holder's review changed no staged value on the final cycle of the week, and every staged row in that cycle carried a verdict and a scenario ID. If the review changed a value, week 2 repeats as week 3 on the same terms.

P8. Week 4 checkpoint: unsupervised execution under audit · recorded in 60 minutes

- Week 3 repeats week 2 on the full assigned scope. From week 4 the candidate deploys within scope without pre-review, with the P5-tier and human-mandatory exceptions permanently intact per Section 1.2.
- The audit is post-deployment and evidence-based. The checkpoint holder reads the cycle's T6 entries against the deployed change set and the T+1 verification report, and checks five things: every deployed row carries a verdict and a scenario ID; every deployed row carries a prediction with a review date; no human-confirmed-tier item deployed unconfirmed; every gate failure executed its gate lever rather than a metric verdict; and last cycle's due rows were scored before this cycle's verdicts were read.
- Record each component-specific week 4 audit competence from the assembled check.
- Distinguish the two finding classes, because the distinction is what stops the ramp from teaching upward-routing of everything. A staged value the checkpoint holder would have chosen differently is a conversation and is recorded as a note. A deployed value that broke the evidence chain, or a human-confirmed-tier item that deployed unconfirmed, is a stop and routes to P12 the same day.

P9. The live defense · 60 to 90 minutes, cold, no documents open

- The questions are the assembled set from P5 step 2 plus the arithmetic-gate questions for any case marked not demonstrated in P3.
- Every question tests why the rule is the rule. A passing answer names the reasoning and the source; an answer that recites a threshold value without its reasoning does not pass, and the reverse is true too: an answer that gives the reasoning without knowing where to find the value is incomplete for a different reason and is marked as such.
- The checkpoint holder marks each question demonstrated or not demonstrated against the source named on the question, so the marking is checkable rather than a judgement about the candidate.
- Where a question's cited rule has changed since the question was written, the question is withdrawn and re-written from the current v4.0 before the session, per P11 step 3. A defence question that tests retired reasoning trains the wrong operator.
- The defense produces a written record of every question, its mark, and for every not-demonstrated answer, the one sentence stating what was missing.

P10. Certification issuance and the matrix wiring · 40 minutes · decision tree

Four branches. The tree is read in order and the first matching branch governs.

Condition	Record state	Action
The target component has no published Element 11	DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11)	No certification issues for that component at any performance level. The deferral names the component and its Ledger due date. The candidate continues on the scope under the ordinary Authority Matrix supervision, and the track re-opens at P5 step 1 when the ramp lands.
Any week 4 audit competence recorded as a stop under P8 step 4	NOT DEMONSTRATED; scope returns to supervised	No certification issues. The scope reverts to week 2 conditions and the specific competence is re-run. The finding routes to P12 where the trigger was an unconfirmed deployment.
All checkpoints closed, one or more competences or defense answers not demonstrated	CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE, WITH NAMED GAPS	Certification issues for the scope, with each gap named on the record and each gap's items routed to the checkpoint holder until cleared. The gap list is the re-test list at P11 step 1. A gap in the routing or refusal competences is not eligible for this branch and falls to the branch above.
All checkpoints closed, all competences and defense answers demonstrated	CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE	Certification issues for the named scope.

- On either certified branch, write the record per Appendix A and route it to the Authority Matrix holder so the tier assignment on the affected rows is an artifact rather than an impression. This routing is the whole reason the record exists.
- Route the certification signal to #46 so the access tier reconciles with the decision tier.
- Route the certification state to the skills-conversion queue, because P13 reads it.
- Set the next standing review date on the record.
- The record names the scope and the component versions it was issued against. A certification with no version pin cannot be invalidated by a rebuild, which is the same defect as never re-testing.

P11. Standing review, re-test and recertification · 30 minutes monthly, 90 minutes quarterly

- Gap clearance, monthly.** Work the named-gap list from P10 branch three. A gap cleared is re-marked demonstrated with its evidence and its date.
- Matrix remap, on re-issue.** When the Authority Matrix re-issues, re-read every competence's source row. A competence whose D or E letter moved is re-tested before the holder next executes that row. This runs within the week the matrix re-issues, because the matrix re-issues within one week of any org change touching its roles per its own Section 2 rule 6.
- Defense re-validation, on v4.0 increment.** Re-read every defense question against the new version. A question whose cited rule changed is re-written, and every holder certified against the old answer re-takes that question.

4. **Ramp re-validation, on component rebuild.** When a component publishes a new Element 11, diff it against the provenance line recorded in P5 step 5. New or changed competences are re-tested on every holder certified for that component.
5. **Override review, monthly.** Read the per-owner override entries in T6 DECISION LOG. v4.0 Section 14 rule V2 makes a falling override rate the quality metric of the system and routes validated overrides back into thresholds, scenarios or skills. Record the direction of the holder's series and route validated overrides to the threshold owner. Do not compute an operator pass or fail from it: v4.0 sets no operator-level threshold on override rate, and one invented here would be exactly the defect this SOP tests candidates for refusing.
6. **Accuracy review, quarterly.** Read the per-owner V5 hit-rate series on Account Rollup A3 Verification scoreboard, which carries hit rate by product, by rule or scenario ID, and by owner. Record the series. v4.0 Section 14 rule V5 sets an accuracy threshold that governs *rules*, not people, and rule V6 recalibrates confidence bands rather than operators; neither is repurposed here as a personal bar. The operator-level bar is amendment item AM-1.
7. **Recertification cadence.** Until component #40 publishes the above-weekly calendar, the standing reviews run on the monthly and quarterly cadence v4.0 Section 14 rule V4 already sets for override review and calibration, and the ritual hands over to #40 on its publication. A recertification interval expressed in months is amendment item AM-3.

P12. Suspension, revocation and re-entry · same day for the suspension branch

1. **Suspension triggers, any one.** A human-confirmed-tier item deployed without its confirmation record. A deployment outside the certified scope. A threshold written into a document, a reason string or a workbook cell without a v4.0 basis. A deployed change with no prediction and no review date, on a repeated basis after the first finding is raised.
2. On trigger: set the record to SUSPENDED the same day, return the scope to week 2 supervised conditions per P7, and notify the access owner at #46 so login rights and decision rights do not diverge.
3. Name the competence, not the person. The suspension record states which competence from the assembled check the event contradicted, so re-entry has a target.
4. **Re-entry.** Re-run the named competence under P7 conditions, then one full cycle under P8 conditions. Two consecutive clean cycles on the named competence returns the record to CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE with the suspension retained in the history. The history is retained because a cleared suspension that vanishes teaches nothing to the next ramp.
5. **Revocation.** The record is set REVOKED on scope withdrawal, on role exit, or on a second suspension for the same competence after re-entry. Revocation routes to #46 the same day and to the Authority Matrix holder so the vacancy rule applies to the emptied rows.
6. Revocation is a scope statement, not a performance verdict, and the record says which of the three causes applied.

P13. The skills-conversion gate · 20 minutes per component

1. Trigger: a skill file for component N enters the conversion queue.
2. Read the certification register for component N. If at least one operator holds CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE covering that component, the gate passes and this SOP records the pass with the holder role and date.
3. If no operator holds it, the gate fails and conversion does not begin. The reason is one line and it is the program's own: a skill reviewed by an uncertified human is an unreviewed skill, so the review that conversion depends on has not happened.
4. Where component N has no Element 11, the gate fails in the DEFERRED state rather than the failed state, and the blocking item is the missing ramp rather than the missing operator. The distinction routes the fix to the right owner.
5. Record the gate result against the component so the register shows, at any moment, which components can convert and which cannot and why.

5. Decision Points: Verdict Mapping

This SOP issues zero verdicts from the closed vocabulary. It writes no K9 cell, stages no bulk row and moves no bid. Its outputs are certification record states, which are record states of this document's own artifact and are not keyword verdicts. Stating that plainly is the mapping, and it follows the precedent of the other governance components that authorize no account action.

5.1 The certification record states this SOP writes

These seven states sit outside the closed vocabulary of v4.0 Section 13.1 "The Closed Verdict Vocabulary". They are recorded on the certification file and in the Authority Matrix tier assignment only. The Cross-Reference Ledger already carries the same class of finding for component #46, whose access-state vocabulary sits outside the closed vocabulary for the same structural reason; this SOP logs it identically as amendment item AM-4 rather than treating its own labels as canon.

Record state	What it asserts and where it is written
IN RAMP	A file is open, scope is named, checkpoints are pending. No scope change. Written on the certification file only.
DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11)	The target component has published no ramp, so no competence set exists to test. Names the component and its Ledger due date. Blocks P13 in the deferred state.
CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE	All competences and defense answers demonstrated for the named scope at the named component versions. Routes to the Authority Matrix tier assignment and to #46.
CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE, WITH NAMED GAPS	As above with an open gap list, each gap routed to the checkpoint holder until cleared. Ineligible where the gap is routing or refusal.
NOT DEMONSTRATED	One or more competences failed at week 4 as a stop. Scope returns to supervised. Not a certification.
SUSPENDED	A P12 trigger fired. Scope returns to supervised the same day; access owner notified.
REVOKED	Scope withdrawn, role exited, or a second suspension on the same competence. Routes to #46 and to the vacancy rule.

5.2 The verdict strings the comprehension check uses, quoted verbatim

The check tests recognition and correct issuance of the closed vocabulary. Every string below is quoted verbatim from the Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0, sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference", which is the source the operating SOPs map against. The candidate is asked for the scenario that fires it and the lever that follows, never for a threshold value.

Verdict string, verbatim	Source	What the check asks
RANK PUSH: FUND SIZED PUSH	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Name the block that must exist before this can issue, and the one number that later ends the push.
TAPER: RANK ACHIEVED, STEP BIDS DOWN	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why the trigger is rank held rather than rank touched, per v4.0 Section 11 rule T1.
STOP-LOSS: CONCEDE OR DEFER	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why a deferral requires a new funded worksheet rather than an informal continuation.
FIX CONVERSION FIRST; DEFER PUSH	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why no bid level closes a conversion deficit, and which owner the drop point routes to.
ADD EXACT + RESTRUCTURE	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why control precedes judgement when a source campaign carries most of a priority term's clicks.
CONTINUE TEST TO 50 CLICKS AT CAPPED BID	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why a striking rate on a thin sample produces no rate verdict, per v4.0 Section 5 gate G2.
QUARANTINE: DATA REFRESH	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why the correct urgent action on bad data is fixing the data, per v4.0 Section 12 rule P8.
GRADUATE FROM DISCOVERY	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why the walls are built in the same session rather than in the next negation pass.
LEAVE TO HARVEST	KDR Template v3.0, "Bands & Verdicts Reference"	Why a tracked, aged pool entry is a decision and an untracked one is a leak.

The four prediction score values the week 4 audit reads, HIT, PARTIAL, MISS and WRONG-DIRECTION, are the T6 DECISION LOG "V5 Score" values defined in Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 Section 9, and the check asks which one requires a written root cause.

5.3 The thresholds this SOP consumes, and the one it does not have

Number the process needs	Source	State
Which actions stay human-confirmed at every tenure	v4.0 Section 12 "Layer 7: Precedence and Conflict Resolution (P1-P10)", rule P5	Available and quoted in Section 1.2
The tightened confirmation line inside Recovery Mode	v4.0 Section 11 "Layer 6: Transitions, Stages, Modes (T1-T8) and Recovery Mode (R1-R6)", rule R3	Available and quoted in Section 1.2
Sample sufficiency, tested in the check	v4.0 Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass", gate G2	Available
What a missing field group blocks	v4.0 Section 5, gate G8	Available

Number the process needs	Source	State
Confidence bands and their effect on step size	v4.0 Section 3 "Layer M: The Master Metric Criteria Dictionary (F1-F16)", family F15; v4.0 Section 10 "Layer 5: Sizing Mathematics (M1-M10). Every Action Carries Numbers", rule M10	Available
Prediction, override and rule-accuracy machinery	v4.0 Section 14 "Layer 9: Verification and Learning (V1-V8)", rules V1, V2, V4, V5, V6, V8	Available; V5 and V6 govern rules and bands, not operators
The certification pass mark	None. The Gap Register names "the established pass bar" from the LTSF rollout precedent, and the LTSF Master Decision and Operations System sits outside this corpus per Ledger conflict C6. v4.0 carries no certification threshold.	Not available. Amendment item AM-1. Until it lands, the record is per-competence demonstrated or not demonstrated, which is a complete and auditable record requiring no threshold, and is what SOP-12 v2.1 Section 11.6 already prescribes.
Maximum allowed lag from any trigger to procedure start	None in v4.0	Not available. Amendment item AM-2. Section 2 states cadence facts from named sources instead.
Recertification interval	None in v4.0	Not available. Amendment item AM-3. P11 step 7 runs on the v4.4 cadence already set for override and calibration review.

6. Worked Examples

All three are illustrative and internally consistent. No anonymized live product economics spine was attached to this session, so every economic figure uses the standard fictional training base stated in the Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0: AOV \$80.00, contribution \$28.00 per order, break-even ACOS 35.0%, Target ACOS 17.5%, Maximum Acceptable 26.3%, CVR 5.2% unless stated. Live records use packet values.

WE-1 · A clean track on component #12, intake to certification

Setup. One incoming operator, scope from the Transition Brief v1.2 stack: steady-state US weekly verdicts on one product, plus the component #12 execution rows. Target component: #12 at v2.1, the one component whose Element 11 has been published. Matrix version v2.0. Ledger row for #12 read and copied at P1 step 3.

P1. File opened, state IN RAMP. Checkpoint holders set from the matrix: the PPC Lead on the weekly-verdict and structure-creation rows, the PPC Manager on the two rows where the matrix places E with the manager. One row carries D with the incoming operator, the incrementality-test row, and it is flagged on the file as the row week 4 audits hardest.

P3 arithmetic gate, marked case by case. Inputs varied, structure held. The candidate computes: $\text{margin } 28.00 / 80.00 = 35.0\%$, so break-even ACOS 35.0%; Target ACOS 17.5%; Maximum Acceptable 26.3%. Maximum profitable CPC = $28.00 \times 0.052 = \$1.46$. Target CPC = $80.00 \times 0.175 \times 0.052 = \0.73 . Loss case: a term at CPC \$2.10 and CVR 5.0% costs $2.10 / 0.05 = \$42.00$ per order against \$28.00 contribution, losing \$14.00 per order; at 40 clicks per week that is \$84.00 spend, 2.0 orders, \$56.00 contribution recovered, \$28.00 net loss per week, \$1,456 per year. Push sizing: order gap 2.4 per day at CVR 5.0% requires $2.4 / 0.05 = 48$ clicks per day; at expected CPC \$2.30 that is \$110.40 per day; over 14 days, \$1,545.60; paid recovery $2.4 \times \$28.00 = \67.20 per day, so expected loss \$43.20 per day and \$604.80 total. Margin-class case: two products both at 32.0% ACOS on \$80.00 AOV carry ad cost per order of \$25.60; at \$28.00 contribution that is +\$2.40 per order, at \$22.40 contribution it is -\$3.20. TACOS identity: $0.35 \times 0.40 = 0.14$. Eight of eight correct on the first attempt.

P4 instrument gate. T7 read lists 5 field groups MISSING and 11 PARTIAL with the blocked verdict class named on each. The candidate names all 16. The T2 expand on one head term shows 4 campaign child rows and the candidate reports the spend share of the keyword per row. Five of five demonstrated.

P6, P7, P8. The nine week 1 competences from the component's own ramp all record demonstrated. Week 2: the checkpoint holder changes two staged values in the first cycle of the week and zero in the final cycle, so week 2 closes on its stated condition. The refusal competence records demonstrated: the candidate identifies one request for a step size the ladder source had not sent, and routes it as an amendment request rather than sizing it. Week 4: six audit competences, all demonstrated; the cycle's chain reads clean from staged set through verification report to decision-log entries; zero human-confirmed-tier items deployed unconfirmed.

P9 live defense. Fourteen questions from the component's own set, asked cold. Fourteen demonstrated. The strongest signal is the push question: the candidate answers that percentage is not the binding constraint inside a sized push, that the loss line is, and that the number which flips the verdict is cumulative loss reaching the ceiling set before the push ran, citing the sizing section. No threshold value is recited and none is asked for.

P10. Branch four. Record state CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE, issued against component #12 v2.1, matrix v2.0, and the v4.0 version on the file. Routed to the Authority Matrix holder for tier assignment, to #46 for access reconciliation, and to the skills-conversion queue. Next standing review dated. **Total elapsed: 4 weeks; total checkpoint-holder time recorded on the file: 25 + 90 + 120 + 60 + 45 + 45 + 60 + 75 + 40 minutes, which is 560 minutes, or 9 hours 20 minutes across four weeks.**

WE-2 · The edge case: a strong candidate, a recited answer, and a deployment that stops the ramp

Setup. Same scope shape as WE-1. The candidate clears P2, P3 with seven of eight cases correct on the first attempt, and P4 with five of five.

The repeat that works. The not-correct case is the cross-format comparison. Re-administered in week 2 against a third variation, the candidate computes it correctly: at SP CPC \$2.10 with SP CVR 5.0% and a qualified read of CPC \$0.95 at CVR 3.2%, the CVR-adjusted cost is $0.95 \times (5.0 / 3.2) = \1.48 per SP-equivalent conversion, which is 29.3% under the SP cost. Marked demonstrated on the second attempt, and the corresponding defense question is added to the P9 set per P3 step 4.

The week 4 finding that stops it. In the week 4 cycle the audit finds one structural change deployed inside the scope without a confirmation record. The item was correct on its merits; the survivor choice would have been the same one the checkpoint holder would have made. That is not the test. Structural changes sit in the permanent human-confirmed tier under v4.0 Section 12 rule P5, and the tier is a property of the action. Under P8 step 4 this is a stop, not a conversation.

P10 and P12. The tree is read in order. Branch one does not apply, the component has a ramp. Branch two applies: record state NOT DEMONSTRATED, scope returns to week 2 supervised conditions the same day, and because the trigger was an unconfirmed deployment the finding also opens P12. The suspension record names the competence, which is the routing competence, rather than naming a quality of the person. Access is notified so decision rights and login rights do not diverge while the scope is supervised.

The defense answer that would have failed anyway. Run in the same week for completeness, the defense returns thirteen of fourteen demonstrated. The one not demonstrated is the confidence question: asked why a LOW-confidence read shrinks the move rather than delaying it, the candidate recites the band boundaries correctly and stops. The band values were not what was asked. The passing answer is that uncertainty buys smaller steps and never bigger ones, so step sizes and budget steps halve and the review horizon shortens, which keeps the account learning at lower cost instead of stopping, per v4.0 Section 10 rule M10. Marked not demonstrated, and it would have forced branch three even without the deployment finding.

Re-entry. The routing competence re-runs under supervised conditions. Two consecutive clean cycles return the record to CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE, WITH NAMED GAPS, the named gap being the confidence answer, which clears at the next standing review. The suspension stays in the history.

Elapsed penalty: 3 additional weeks, of which 2 are the consecutive clean cycles the re-entry rule requires.

WE-3 · The boundary case: a skill reaches the conversion queue on a component with no ramp

Setup. A skill file for a component other than #12 enters the conversion queue. The certification register is read at P13 step 2.

The read. Certified operators covering that component: zero. Element 11 published for that component: none. The register shows the track for that component at DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11) with the Ledger due date recorded against it.

The distinction that decides the routing. Two different failures produce the same certified-operator count of zero and they route to different owners. If the component had a ramp and simply nobody had run it, the blocking item would be an unrun certification and the owner would be the PPC Lead scheduling an intake. Here the component has no ramp, so the blocking item is the missing Element 11 and the owner is that component's owner. P13 step 4 fails the gate in the DEFERRED state and names the second owner. Conversion does not begin in either case, and the program's own definition-of-done addition is the reason: a skill reviewed by an uncertified human is an unreviewed skill.

What is not done. A comprehension check is not written for the component in order to unblock the queue. Writing one here would produce a test traceable to this document's judgement rather than to a matrix row, it would not aggregate with the ramp that eventually arrives, and it would certify against competences the owning component has never declared. The queue waits, the finding routes, and the certification register shows exactly which components can convert and which cannot, with the reason attached to each.

Scale of the block at this version. Components with a published Element 11: 1. Components consuming this SOP per the Ledger row: 23. So 22 of 23 tracks open DEFERRED at v1.0, and the skills-conversion gate reads DEFERRED for 22 components. That number falls by one for each Element 11 that publishes, which is why P11 step 4 exists.

7. Failure Modes and Escalation

Failure	Detection signal	Response
F1. Certification asserted without a matrix row behind it	A competence on the certification file whose source column is blank, or names a house standard rather than an Authority Matrix v2.0 row	The competence is struck and re-derived from the matrix, or removed. A ramp built on preferences cannot be aggregated across components, which is the one property this SOP exists to provide.
F2. A pass mark invented to close the record	Any percentage, score or count on a certification file that functions as a pass or fail bar	Strike it the same day. The record reverts to per-competence marks. The requested bar routes as amendment item AM-1. This is the failure the refusal competence in P7 step 3 is a rehearsal for, and the process failing it is worse than a candidate failing it.
F3. Week 4 read as a promotion out of the confirmed tier	A certified holder deploying a human-confirmed-tier item without its confirmation record	P12 suspension the same day. Week 4 changes who drafts and who deploys the routine tail; it moves no item out of the tier set by v4.0 Section 12 rule P5.
F4. Certification issued against an unpinned version	A certification record with no component version, matrix version or v4.0 version on it	The record is re-issued with its pins before it routes anywhere. Without pins, a component rebuild cannot invalidate the competence it changed, and the register silently overstates coverage.
F5. Stale defense questions	A defense answer citing a v4.0 rule that the current version has amended or moved	Withdraw and re-write the question from the current version before the session, per P11 step 3. Re-test every holder certified against the old answer. A question that tests retired reasoning trains the wrong operator and does it with the program's own authority behind it.

Failure	Detection signal	Response
F6. Competence recorded blank rather than not demonstrated	A closed checkpoint with an unmarked row	The checkpoint does not close. A blank reads as a pass to every later reader and as a gap to none, which is the worst of both.
F7. Access and certification diverge	An access-register row at a tier with no certification behind it, or a CERTIFIED FOR SCOPE record with no access row	Route both directions to #46 the same day. Login rights above decision rights is the exposure; decision rights above login rights is a person certified to do work they cannot reach, which quietly returns the work to the checkpoint holder.
F8. Suspension recorded as a judgement about the person	A suspension record that names no competence from the assembled check	Re-write naming the competence. Re-entry needs a target, and a suspension without one has no exit condition, which converts a correction into a status.
F9. A ramp written here for a component that has not written its own	A comprehension check whose provenance line names this document rather than the owning component's Element 11	Withdraw the check; return the track to DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11); route the gap to the owning component. This failure is under standing pressure because it is the fastest way to unblock a skills-conversion queue, and it is the reason 22 tracks read deferred at v1.0 rather than reading certified against invented tests.
F10. Certification treated as permanent	A holder whose record shows no standing review since issuance while the matrix, v4.0 or the component has incremented	Run P11 steps 2 to 4 immediately for every increment since issuance. Certification is issued against named versions and it ages exactly as fast as they do.
F11. The register overstates coverage	Certified-operator count above zero for a component whose only certifications carry no version pin, or were issued on a superseded Element 11	Re-mark those records pending re-test, correct the register the same day, and re-run P13 on any component whose conversion gate passed on the strength of them. This is the failure with the longest fuse, because it is discovered downstream in the skills program rather than here.

Escalation. F2 and F3 escalate on first occurrence: an invented pass mark and an unconfirmed deployment are the two events that damage the system rather than the record. F9 escalates on first occurrence to the owning component's owner and to the PPC Lead together, because the fix is a build, not a correction. All other modes escalate on the second occurrence within two consecutive standing reviews, with the certification history attached.

8. Outputs and Artifacts

Event	Named record and where it is stored	Retention and downstream consumer
Intake (P1)	The certification file, one per operator per scope, per the Appendix A schema; stored with the Authority Matrix and the Transition Brief in the program document set	Retained for the life of the role plus one full recertification cycle after revocation. Consumed by the checkpoint holder and by every later reader deciding whether a scope was earned.
Reading and gates (P2, P3, P4)	The reading-order completion list; the arithmetic-gate marking sheet, per case; the instrument-gate artifacts, which are the candidate's own manifest read, drill note, T2 expand note and family-board note	Retained with the file. Consumed at P9, where any not-demonstrated case becomes a cold defense question.
Check assembly (P5)	The assembled comprehension check with its provenance line: component number, document version, Element 11 section, Ledger version	Retained until the component next rebuilds. Consumed by P11 step 4, which cannot diff a check that has no provenance line.
Checkpoints (P6, P7, P8)	Three checkpoint records, each a per-competence demonstrated or not-demonstrated table with the evidence artifact and reviewing role named per row	Retained with the file. Consumed by P10 and, for the gap list, by P11 step 1.
Live defense (P9)	The defense record: every question, its mark, and one sentence per not-demonstrated answer stating what was missing	Retained with the file. Consumed by P10, and by P11 step 3 on any v4.0 increment.
Issuance (P10)	The certification record with its three version pins and its scope statement	Retained permanently as the audit trail of who held what when. Consumed by the Authority Matrix tier assignment, by #46, and by P13.
Standing review (P11)	The review record: gap movements, remap results, re-test results, the per-owner override direction and the per-owner V5 series as recorded observations	Retained for the current and prior review. Consumed by the threshold owner for validated overrides and by the amendment brief.
Suspension and revocation (P12)	The suspension or revocation record naming the competence and the cause	Retained in the file history permanently, including after re-entry clears it. Consumed by #46 and by the vacancy-rule holders.
Conversion gate (P13)	The per-component gate result: passed with holder role and date, failed, or deferred with the blocking item	Retained per component until the component's next rebuild. Consumed by the skills-conversion queue.
The register	The certification register: one row per component showing certified holders, deferral state, and conversion-gate result	The standing artifact of this SOP. Consumed by the program owner, and it is the artifact that answers whether the operation can be handed to anyone at all.

9. Skill-Conversion Block

Block	Specification
Input bindings	The Cross-Reference Ledger row set, read for the Owns exclusively and Interfaces cells of every target component and for this component's own row. Each target component's Element 11 competence rows, live-defense questions and provenance data. PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 1 "The Matrix" cells and Section 2 "Standing Rules" 4, 5 and 6. The Transition Brief v1.2 scope stack. Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0 cases E1 to E8 with their input variables exposed so variants generate. Command Workbook tabs T0 through T7 for the instrument gate, with T7 MANIFEST columns "Catalog ID + Field Group", "Status" and "Verdict Classes Blocked While Missing" read as a set. T6 DECISION LOG rows filtered to owner and to review date. Account Rollup A3 Verification scoreboard per-owner series. The #46 access register state per candidate. Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0 sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference" for the verdict-string items. An absent binding suppresses only its own gate and is written on the checkpoint record; it never lowers a competence.
Deterministic logic	Competence-row extraction from a published Element 11, unedited. Arithmetic-variant generation from the E1 to E8 structures with changed inputs, and marking each variant against a recomputed expected value. Instrument-gate marking by set comparison: the candidate's named blocked-verdict-class list against the T7 column contents, where a proper subset is a return. Checkpoint-state resolution and the P10 four-branch tree in its stated order. Provenance diffing at P11 step 4: old check against new Element 11, producing the re-test list. Register roll-up per component: certified count, deferral state, conversion-gate result. No local thresholds, and specifically no aggregate score: the logic produces marks and lists, never a pass percentage.
Human checkpoints, drawn from Authority Matrix v2.0 rows	AI-executable with audit: check assembly and its provenance line, arithmetic-variant generation and marking, instrument-gate set comparison, register roll-up, standing-review data assembly, the P11 step 4 diff, and drafting every record for confirmation. Human-mandatory: every demonstrated or not-demonstrated mark on a competence, because the matrix places D on the checkpoint holder for the rows the competence covers; the live defense in full, since it is a cold verbal test; the P10 issuance decision; the P12 suspension and revocation calls; and the P13 gate result. The row "v4.0 threshold changes" places the operator and this SOP at I, which is why the pass-mark gap routes rather than resolves.
Cadence	Per intake for P1 through P10. Same day for the P12 suspension branch and for any unconfirmed-deployment finding. Monthly for the P11 gap clearance and override review. Quarterly for the P11 accuracy review. On event for the matrix remap, the v4.0 defense re-validation and the ramp re-validation. Per queue entry for P13.
Alarm specification	F1 to F11 each carry a detection signal from Section 7 and an evidence-line format: certification file ID, competence ID, the source cell or artifact, and the version pin in force. Routing tier: F2, F3 and F9 same day to the PPC Lead, and F9 additionally to the owning component's owner; F4, F7 and F11 into the monthly standing review with the register correction attached; F1, F5, F6, F8 and F10 onto the next checkpoint's worklist.
Skill outputs	Drafted certification files, assembled checks with provenance lines, generated arithmetic variants with their expected values, drafted checkpoint records queued for human marking, the standing-review data pack, the P11 step 4 re-test list, the certification register, and F1 to F11 alarms with evidence lines.

10. Version Governance

Owner: PPC Lead, intake by CEO. Registered in the Supersession Map at publication. First build; no predecessor and nothing carried forward. Review triggers, each specific to this component:

1. **Any Element 11 publication or amendment on any component.** This is the highest-frequency trigger by design, because the component's own scope is the aggregation of those ramps and every one that lands moves a track out of the deferred state. The register updates on each; Section 1.4 restates its count.
2. **Any PPC Authority Matrix re-issue.** Every competence in this document traces to a matrix row, and the matrix re-issues within one week of any org change touching its roles. A moved letter moves a competence.
3. **Any v4.0 increment that changes a rule cited in a defense answer or in Section 5.3.** The pass-mark, lag and interval amendment items land here, and their arrival is the largest single change this document will absorb.
4. **Any Cross-Reference Ledger version that rewrites the row for component 44 or the row of any counterparty named in Sections 12.2 or 12.3.** An interface contract written against a superseded row is a contract with nobody.
5. **Publication of component #40.** The recertification ritual hands over to the above-weekly calendar at that point and P11 step 7 shortens accordingly.
6. **Publication of a procedural document for component #31, or any resolution of Ledger conflict C3.** Any competence citing envelope decisions currently names the instrument rather than a procedure number and would be re-pointed.
7. **Resolution of the verdict-count finding in Section 12.4.** The comprehension check tests a vocabulary, and the vocabulary's own count is currently reported three different ways across the canon.

Companions: Master PPC Decision Criteria System v4.0 (every threshold and every verdict) · PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 (every competence's source row) · PPC Operations Transition Brief v1.2 (scope) · PPC Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0 (the arithmetic gate) · Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 and PPC Command Workbook TEMPLATE v1.0 (the instrument gate) · Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0 (the verdict strings) · PPC SOP-12 Exact Campaign Operations v2.1 Sections 11 and 12 (the one published ramp and the interface-contract pattern) · PPC Cross-Reference Ledger (ownership boundaries) · PPC SOP Program Gap Register v1.0 (this component's charter and the definition-of-done addition).

11. Operator Ramp

VERDICT: an incoming holder of this SOP holds it when a certification file they produced can be handed to a third reader who can verify every mark against its source without asking a question, and when they have declined at least once to write a number this system does not carry. The ramp is 8 Authority Matrix v2.0 rows read across 3 checkpoints: week 1 observation and artifact familiarity, week 2 supervised administration with the checkpoint holder reviewing every record before it routes, week 4 unsupervised administration with the checkpoint holder auditing after the fact. Week 4 does not confer the right to set a pass mark, and it does not move one item out of the human-confirmed tier fixed by v4.0 Section 12 "Layer 7: Precedence and Conflict Resolution (P1-P10)", rule P5.

11.1 The Authority Matrix rows this SOP touches

Every competence below is one row of PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 1 "The Matrix" turned into something a person demonstrates. D decides, E executes, R reviews, I is informed, per the matrix legend. This SOP does not appear as a matrix row of its own, which is itself a finding: the Gap Register requires the certification record to be wired into the matrix, and that wiring is a matrix edit rather than a clause written here. It is routed in Section 12.4.

Authority Matrix v2.0 row	D holder	This SOP's holder	What this SOP does under the row
v4.0 threshold changes	CEO	I	Nothing, and the row is in the ramp because it is the authority fact behind Sections 1.4 and 5.3. A pass mark this SOP wants and v4.0 does not carry is an amendment request, never a number written onto a certification file.
Weekly verdicts (established US)	PPC Lead	R	The scope most tracks certify against. This SOP reads the cycle's artifacts as evidence at P8; it issues no verdict and reviews no verdict on its merits.
Structure creation (all SOPs)	PPC Lead, or per SOP scope	R	The competence class that stops ramps most often, because structural changes sit permanently in the confirmed tier. P8 step 4 and F3 are written for this row.
Incrementality tests	Incoming operator, per the Transition Brief v1.2 scope stack	R	The one row where a certifying candidate may hold D. A track covering it audits it hardest at week 4, because a held D with no checkpoint above it is the only place an uncaught habit compounds silently.
Sibling declarations (S-series)	PPC Lead	I	Nothing directly. The competence is that the candidate checks the declared owner before scaling a shared term, which is a routing competence rather than a decision competence.
Automation rules (#37)	PPC Lead	I	P13 only: the human precondition on conversion. Rule content, registration and reconciliation are not this SOP's.
Bulk deployments (#38)	No D on this row; the PPC Lead reviews	I	Nothing. The deployment artifacts are read as week 4 audit evidence. Matrix standing rule 2 governs the candidate: E without D executes staged decisions only.
Code-red declaration and close	PPC Lead	I	Nothing, except that a scope certified outside Recovery Mode is executing against the tightened confirmation line the moment Recovery Mode is declared. P11 step 2 re-reads the affected competences on declaration.

Scope, vacancy and the rows this ramp does not confer. The scope of any certification issued comes from the Transition Brief v1.2 stack per matrix standing rule 4, not from this document. The rows "Launch-stage verdicts + batches" and "Canada weekly block" carry D and E with the launch and CA operator and stay outside every steady-state track until the brief assigns otherwise. Where a checkpoint holder role is unfilled at any point, standing rule 5 applies: D reverts to the PPC Lead and E to the PPC Manager until filled, the substitution is recorded on the file at P1 step 5, and the ramp continues against those holders rather than pausing.

11.2 Week 1: observation and artifact familiarity

No certification issues, no checkpoint is marked, and no record routes under the incoming holder's name in week 1. The test of week 1 is not whether the holder agrees with how a track was run; it is whether every mark on an existing certification file can be traced to its source without help.

ID	Competence demonstrated	Demonstration	Evidence artifact and reviewer
W1.1	Read the ramp before the person (matrix row: structure creation)	Open SOP-12 v2.1 Section 11 and list every competence row with the matrix row it traces to. State which two matrix rows the ramp explicitly does not confer.	Written trace list; PPC Lead. A list naming fewer matrix rows than the ramp cites is returned.
W1.2	The permanent tier (Section 1.2)	State the six item classes that stay human-confirmed at every tenure, and the two that tighten inside Recovery Mode, naming the v4.0 rule for each set.	Written statement; PPC Lead.

ID	Competence demonstrated	Demonstration	Evidence artifact and reviewer
W1.3	Provenance literacy (P5 step 5)	Take one assembled comprehension check and reconstruct, from its provenance line alone, which component version it was built from and what would invalidate it.	Reconstruction note; PPC Manager.
W1.4	The deferral is real (Section 1.4)	Read the certification register and count the components at DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11). For two of them, name the owning component and its Ledger due date.	Register read; PPC Lead.
W1.5	The arithmetic gate from the marker's side (P3)	Take cases E1, E3 and E8 from the Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0, generate one variant of each with changed inputs, and compute the expected value for each variant.	Three variants with worked expected values; PPC Lead. A variant whose expected value the holder cannot compute cannot be marked.
W1.6	Instrument-gate marking (P4 step 2)	Open T7 MANIFEST on one product and produce the full reference list of MISSING and PARTIAL groups with their entries in the "Verdict Classes Blocked While Missing" column, which is what a candidate's read is compared against.	Reference list; PPC Manager.
W1.7	Authority literacy	For each of the eight rows in 11.1, state who holds D in the scope being certified and what standing rule 5 does if that holder is absent.	Row-by-row statement; PPC Lead.
W1.8	Reading the two finding classes (P8 step 4)	From one closed week 4 audit, separate the notes from the stops and state, for each stop, which tier or chain it broke.	Separated list; PPC Lead. Misclassifying a stop as a note is the error this competence exists to catch.
W1.9	Observe a live defense	Sit one full defense session read-only. Mark nothing. Afterwards, state for two questions what the passing answer contained beyond the threshold value.	Two written answer analyses; PPC Lead.

Week 1 closes when all nine competences carry a mark. A competence not demonstrated repeats in week 2 alongside the week 2 work; it does not block the ramp and it does not quietly disappear.

11.3 Week 2: supervised administration

The holder administers; the checkpoint holder reviews every record before it routes anywhere. The supervision is on the record, not on the person: the reviewer reads the mark and its evidence artifact, and the mark either traces to a source or it fails review.

ID	Competence demonstrated	Supervised task	Review test the checkpoint holder applies
W2.1	Open a track correctly (P1)	Open one certification file end to end: scope copied verbatim from the brief, Ledger cells copied, holders set from the matrix, three version pins set.	All three pins present. The scope statement matches the brief word for word; a scope improved in the copying is returned.
W2.2	Assemble a check without authoring one (P5)	Assemble the comprehension check for one component from its published Element 11.	Every competence row appears unedited and the provenance line is complete. Any row the holder wrote is struck on sight, per F9.
W2.3	Administer and mark the arithmetic gate (P3)	Run all eight cases as variants and mark them.	Each mark is against a recomputed expected value shown on the sheet. No aggregate percentage appears anywhere on the record, per F2.
W2.4	Mark an instrument gate by set comparison (P4)	Mark one candidate's T7 read against the reference list.	A proper subset is returned rather than partially credited. Partial credit here would be a pass mark by another name.
W2.5	Record the refusal competence (P7 step 3)	Identify, in the candidate's week, whether a request for an ungoverned number was routed as an amendment or executed.	The mark is not demonstrated where nothing was declined all week, rather than waived. A holder who waives it has failed W2.5, not the candidate.
W2.6	The four-branch tree in order (P10)	Resolve one completed track through the P10 tree.	The branches are read in order and the first match governs. A track resolved to branch three where branch two applied is the specific error, because it converts a stop into a named gap.
W2.7	The refusal, on the holder's own side (matrix row: v4.0 threshold changes)	Identify one request in the week to place a pass mark, a lag limit or a recertification interval onto a record, and route it as an amendment item instead.	The routed item names what the decision needs and states that v4.0 does not answer it. Demonstrated by declining; a holder who never declines has not demonstrated it.
W2.8	Route on issuance (P10 steps 1-3)	Route one issued record to the matrix holder, to #46 and to the conversion queue.	Three routings, each with a date. A record issued and not routed certifies nobody, because the tier assignment is where certification becomes real.

Week 2 closes when the checkpoint holder's review changed no mark and no record on the final track of the week, and every mark on that track traced to a named source.

11.4 Week 4: unsupervised administration under audit

Week 3 repeats week 2 across the full set of open tracks. From week 4 the holder administers and routes within scope without pre-review, with two permanent exceptions and one audit.

- 1. Issuance and revocation stay confirmed.** The P10 issuance decision, the P12 suspension and revocation calls, and the P13 gate result remain human-mandatory with the checkpoint holder, because each of them changes what another person is authorized to deploy.
- 2. No pass mark is created at any tenure.** The absence of AM-1 is a standing condition of this document, not a gap week 4 closes. A holder who resolves it locally has failed week 4 rather than completed it.
- 3. The audit is post-issuance and evidence-based.** The checkpoint holder reads the week's certification files and checks five things: every mark traces to a named source; every issued record carries three version pins; every deferral names its component and due date; every suspension names a competence; and every issued record shows its three routings with dates.

ID	Competence demonstrated	Audit evidence the checkpoint holder reads
W4.1	Ownership of the full track for the open scope set, intake through issuance.	The week's certification files read as one chain: file, gates, checkpoints, defense, issuance, routings. A break anywhere in the chain is the finding.
W4.2	Holding the pass-mark line under pressure.	Every record in the week, scanned for any number functioning as a bar. One occurrence stops the ramp the same day and returns the scope to supervised administration.
W4.3	Holding the deferral line under conversion-queue pressure.	The conversion-gate results against the register. A gate passed on a component with no published Element 11 is a stop, and it is the same stop as W4.2 wearing different clothes.
W4.4	Running the standing review to its stated cadence (P11).	The monthly gap and override records, and any event-triggered remap or re-validation, present with dates and observations rather than conclusions.
W4.5	Producing the F1 to F11 alarm set with evidence lines and routing each per Section 9.	Alarm list with certification file ID, competence ID, source cell and version pin on each line; routing matches the tier.
W4.6	Holding the boundary: naming the owning component for every decision this SOP does not make.	Every item routed out in the week names its component by number per Section 1.3, with no restatement of that component's procedure.

Audit findings return as competence gaps rather than as reversals of issued records. An issued certification is not withdrawn because the checkpoint holder would have marked one competence differently; that is a conversation and a re-test. It is withdrawn when a mark traces to nothing, which is F1 and F4 together.

11.5 Live-defense questions

Twelve questions, asked cold at the end of week 4. None asks for a threshold's value, and an answer that recites a number without its reasoning does not pass. The sources are named so the reviewer checks the answer rather than judging it.

Q	Question	What a passing answer contains, and its source
Q1	A candidate has cleared every checkpoint. Why does certification still not permit deploying a structural change without confirmation?	The confirmed tier is a property of the action, not of the operator, so no tenure removes an item from it; certification grants scope, and scope is which actions the person may draft and deploy, not which confirmations may be skipped. Source: v4.0 Section 12 "Layer 7: Precedence and Conflict Resolution (P1-P10)", rule P5.
Q2	The program asks for a single pass percentage so certification can be reported on one line. What do you do?	Write it nowhere. Name what the decision needs, state that v4.0 carries no certification threshold and that the referenced precedent sits outside this corpus, and file it as an amendment item. The per-competence record is already complete and auditable without it. Source: v4.0 Section 14 "Layer 9: Verification and Learning (V1-V8)", rule V3; Authority Matrix row "v4.0 threshold changes", where this SOP is I.
Q3	Why is a competence written by this SOP for a component that has not published its Element 11 worse than no competence at all?	It certifies against competences the owning component never declared, it traces to this document's judgement rather than to a matrix row, and it cannot be aggregated with the ramp that eventually arrives, so it produces a record that reads as coverage and is not. Source: this SOP Section 1.4 and failure mode F9; SOP-12 v2.1 Section 11.6 on why every competence traces to a matrix row.
Q4	An operator's override rate is falling steadily. Why is that not a certification pass?	A falling override rate is the quality metric of the system as a whole and validated overrides fold back into thresholds, scenarios or skills; v4.0 sets no operator-level threshold on it, so reading a personal bar into it invents the number the process exists to refuse. Source: v4.0 Section 14, rule V2.
Q5	Rule-level prediction accuracy has a review threshold. Why can it not serve as the operator pass mark?	It governs rules, not people: a rule below the line enters review and produces an amendment, a threshold change or a documented defence of the rule. Applying a rule-level bar to a person measures a different thing and would attribute rule error to the operator executing it. Source: v4.0 Section 14, rule V5.
Q6	Why does the reading order put the doctrine before the Criteria System rather than after it?	The doctrine explains why the rules are what they are so an operator can extend them to cases the rules have not met; met in the other order, thresholds arrive as arbitrary values to memorize and the first unfamiliar case produces an invented rule. Source: PPC Strategic Doctrine v1.0 Section 1 "Verdict and First Principles"; the reading order in the SOP Program Gap Register v1.0 entry for this component.

Q	Question	What a passing answer contains, and its source
Q7	A candidate's manifest read names four blocked verdict classes; the manifest lists seven. Why is that returned rather than marked partially?	The gate exists so that analysis states what it could not see, and a read that understates the blocked set produces confident verdicts on a silently incomplete packet, which is the most expensive failure the system can produce. Partial credit would also be an aggregate score by another name. Source: v4.0 Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass", gate G8.
Q8	Why does the arithmetic gate change the inputs rather than asking for the published cases?	Reproducing the training base tests recall; recomputing from changed inputs tests the arithmetic move, which is the thing every operator decision reduces to. The set itself prescribes variation for exactly this reason. Source: PPC Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0, "Use and Governance".
Q9	Two findings in a week 4 audit: a staged value you would have chosen differently, and a confirmed-tier item deployed unconfirmed. Why do these route differently?	Correcting judgement teaches an operator to route everything upward, which reproduces the bottleneck the ramp exists to clear, so it is a conversation; a broken confirmation is a tier violation and stops the ramp. The distinction is what makes the ramp end in ownership rather than in permanent supervision. Source: this SOP P8 step 4; the same distinction in SOP-12 v2.1 Section 11.4.
Q10	An SOP you certified three operators against publishes a new Element 11. What happens to the three records?	Diff the new ramp against the provenance line recorded when the check was assembled; new and changed competences re-test on all three. The records are pinned to component versions precisely so a rebuild can invalidate what it changed rather than silently ageing the register into overstatement. Source: this SOP P11 step 4 and failure modes F4 and F11.
Q11	A skill is ready for conversion and the component has one certified operator whose record carries no version pin. Does the gate pass?	No. An unpinned record cannot be tied to the component version the skill is being built from, so the human review the gate depends on cannot be shown to have covered the current document. The record re-issues with pins or re-tests; the queue waits. Source: this SOP P13 and F11; the definition-of-done addition in the SOP Program Gap Register v1.0.
Q12	A checkpoint holder role is vacant halfway through a ramp. Why does the ramp continue rather than pause?	The vacancy rule already names the substitute: the unfilled role's D reverts to the PPC Lead and its E to the PPC Manager until filled. Pausing would make certification hostage to headcount, and the substitution is recorded so a later reader knows which role signed each mark. Source: PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 2 "Standing Rules", rule 5.

11.6 What this ramp cannot certify

Three things, stated so they are not discovered as gaps. First, no aggregate pass mark exists for this ramp any more than for the ramps it administers; the holder's own record is per-competence, and the same amendment item AM-1 closes both. Second, this ramp cannot confer authority over any matrix row where this SOP is I, which is six of the eight rows in 11.1: certifying the administrator does not move a letter. Third, until Element 11 lands across the library, a holder can only demonstrate W2.2 and W2.4 against the one published ramp, so the aggregation competence, which is the whole point of this component, is demonstrated at a sample of one. That is recorded on the holder's file as a stated limit rather than treated as a pass, and it clears as the ramps arrive.

12. Interface Contracts

VERDICT: every handoff into and out of certification is an artifact with a named sending owner, a named receiving owner, a stated time and a stated consequence when it does not arrive. Twenty-four contracts follow, 14 upstream and 10 downstream, drawn from the Cross-Reference Ledger row for component 44 and the rows of every counterparty that names it, with artifact names and tab locations taken from Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 and the PPC Command Workbook TEMPLATE v1.0. The non-arrival rule is uniform: a handoff that does not arrive suppresses its dependent gate and is recorded on the certification file. It never lowers a competence and it never authorizes a substitute number.

12.1 The five standing contract rules

ID	Rule
C1	The artifact is the interface. A verbal confirmation that a candidate is ready, or a recollection that a competence was shown, does not start or close anything here. If the artifact is not in its named location, the handoff has not arrived, however confident both parties are.
C2	Non-arrival is recorded, not absorbed. The affected gate is marked on the certification file with what it blocks, in the same manner gate G8 requires of the packet manifest: the record states what it could not see. Source: v4.0 Section 5 "Layer 0: Gates (G1-G12). Nothing Proceeds Until These Pass", gate G8.
C3	Suppression, never substitution. A missing input suppresses its gate. It does not license a shorter check, an assumed competence, an estimated pass, or a mark carried over from a prior version without its date.
C4	Cite the Ledger row, not the counterparty's procedure number. Components rebuilt in a later wave move their procedure numbers, and the corpus-wide correction register already carries roughly 40 owed corrections across six documents for exactly this reason. Every contract below names its counterparty by component number and by the Ledger row that declares its ownership. Where a procedure number appears it is this SOP's own.
C5	No contract below carries a maximum lag in hours or days, because v4.0 contains no interface-lag threshold. The times stated are cadence facts from the named source. A lag limit is amendment item AM-2 in Section 12.4.

12.2 Upstream contracts: what must arrive before this SOP acts

ID	Artifact and where it lands	Sending to receiving owner	Timing	When it does not arrive
I-1	The target component's Element 11 competence rows, live-defense questions and week-by-week structure, cited by its Ledger row	Each operating component's owner to the PPC Lead	Before any intake on that scope; #12's landed at v2.1 and is dated to this component at 2026-09-25	The track opens DEFERRED (NO ELEMENT 11) and no certification issues for that component at any performance level. P13 fails in the deferred state and names the owning component rather than the absent operator. This is the standing state for 22 of 23 components at v1.0.
I-2	PPC Authority Matrix v2.0 Section 1 "The Matrix" and Section 2 "Standing Rules"	#3 owner to the PPC Lead	At intake, and within one week of any org change touching its roles	Competences cannot be sourced and no checkpoint is marked. A mark made against a superseded matrix is F1 and is struck when found, which is more expensive than the delay.
I-3	The scope statement from the Transition Brief v1.2 stack	Transition owner to the PPC Lead	At intake	No file opens. A certification with no scope certifies everything and therefore nothing, and the brief is the scope source per matrix standing rule 4.
I-4	Economics Worked-Example Set v1.0, cases E1 to E8 with their input structures	#11 owner to the PPC Lead	Before P3	The arithmetic gate is suppressed and recorded as such. The ramp continues; the gate reopens on arrival and the candidate takes it before P9, because the defense questions for failed cases come from it.
I-5	PPC Command Workbook TEMPLATE v1.0 READ ME and the live product workbook for the scope, tabs T0 PRODUCT COMMAND through T7 MANIFEST	Instrument owner to the PPC Lead	Before P4	The instrument gate is suppressed. The candidate cannot be marked on reads of tabs they cannot open, and a competence marked on a screenshot is not a competence.
I-6	Field-group and manifest definitions behind the T7 columns "Catalog ID + Field Group" and "Verdict Classes Blocked While Missing"	#39 owner to the PPC Lead, per the Ledger row that places feed definitions there	Before P4 step 2	The instrument gate's reference list cannot be built, so the candidate's read cannot be marked by set comparison and P4 step 2 is suppressed rather than marked by impression.
I-7	The current v4.0 version string and the landed amendment batch	Threshold owner, CEO deciding per the matrix row, to the PPC Lead	Before any live defense	Defense questions may test retired reasoning. P11 step 3 cannot run without knowing what changed, so every defense in the interval is provisional and re-validates on arrival.
I-8	Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0, sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference", as the verdict-string source	Template owner to the PPC Lead	Before P5 step 3	The vocabulary items are omitted from the check and the omission is written on the provenance line. They are not reconstructed from memory, which would be the exact drift the closed vocabulary exists to prevent.

12.2 Upstream contracts, continued (I-9 to I-14)

ID	Artifact and where it lands	Sending to receiving owner	Timing	When it does not arrive
I-9	The access-register row for the candidate at the tier the ramp requires	#46 owner to the PPC Lead	Before week 2, when staging begins	Week 2 cannot start; the candidate stays in week 1 observation. Recorded as a blocked gate against #46 rather than as a competence not demonstrated, because the candidate did not fail anything.
I-10	Per-owner V5 hit-rate series on Account Rollup A3 Verification scoreboard	Data Operations to the PPC Lead	Quarterly, with the P11 accuracy review	P11 step 6 records NO EVIDENCE AVAILABLE. It does not record a favourable read, and it does not defer the review, because the absence is itself the finding and routes to Data Operations.
I-11	Per-owner override entries in T6 DECISION LOG for the certified scope	The scope's PPC Lead to the certification holder	Monthly, with the P11 override review	The override review has no input and records the gap. Validated overrides that would have folded into thresholds do not reach the threshold owner, which is a slow loss rather than a visible one.
I-12	The current Cross-Reference Ledger, for the Owns exclusively and Interfaces cells of every target component	Ledger owner to the PPC Lead	At intake and at every P11 step 4 diff	P1 step 3 cannot copy a boundary and P5 step 4 cannot build routing items. Checks assembled against a superseded row test ownership that has moved, which is the stale-reference class the Ledger already tracks corpus-wide.
I-13	Prediction-score outputs and the four score values, per the Ledger row for #06	#06 owner to the PPC Lead	With the week 4 audit and the quarterly review	Standing condition rather than an exception at this version: #06 carries no step-level procedures, so the scoring competence is marked from the T6 "V5 Score" column directly and the dependency is recorded. It is not treated as satisfied.

ID	Artifact and where it lands	Sending to receiving owner	Timing	When it does not arrive
I-14	Component status and wave order from the Operations Definition Register and the Gap Register	#1 owner to the PPC Lead	Before P2 step 5	The reading order cannot be sequenced past the canon layer. P2 steps 1 to 4 still run, since they are component-independent, and step 5 waits.

12.3 Downstream contracts: what this SOP owes, and to whom

ID	Artifact and where it lands	Sending to receiving owner	Timing	When it does not arrive
I-15	The certification record with its three version pins and its scope statement, into the Authority Matrix tier assignment	PPC Lead to #3 owner	Same day as issuance	Tier assignment stays an impression, which is the precise defect this component was chartered to close. The operator is doing certified work with no artifact behind the authority, and the next org change erases the fact entirely.
I-16	The per-component certified-operator count and gate result, into the skills-conversion queue	PPC Lead to #37 owner and the skills program	Per queue entry, and on every issuance	Conversion proceeds without its human precondition and a skill enters production reviewed by nobody certified on the component it automates. The program's own definition of done names this as the failure to prevent.
I-17	Scope-grant confirmation naming the components and the assigned rows	PPC Lead to the scope's PPC Lead and the PPC Manager	Same day as issuance	The weekly pass keeps routing the certified scope to the checkpoint holder, so the bottleneck the ramp cleared reappears with no visible cause and the certification looks ineffective rather than unannounced.
I-18	Access-tier request on certification, and the revocation or suspension notice	PPC Lead to #46 owner	Same day as issuance, suspension or revocation	Decision rights and login rights diverge. On the suspension side this is the exposure: a suspended operator retains the credentials the suspension was meant to constrain, and #46's own weekly reconciliation diff is what eventually finds it.
I-19	Competence-gap findings and defense-answer failures, returned to the owning component	PPC Lead to each component's owner	At each issuance, aggregated monthly	Ramps stop improving. A competence that three candidates in a row fail is a ramp defect rather than three operator defects, and only this handoff can distinguish them.
I-20	Requests for ungoverned numbers, routed as v4.1 amendment candidates with what the decision needed	PPC Lead to the threshold owner, CEO deciding	Monthly, with the standing review	The gaps stay gaps and the pressure to write a local number rises every cycle. AM-1 to AM-4 in Section 12.4 exist because this handoff ran at build time; a process that stops running it eventually writes the number.
I-21	The certification register, into the Operations Definition Register run ledger and the Supersession Map	PPC Lead to #1 owner	At each register change	Program status reports coverage the register cannot evidence. Component status and operator coverage are different facts, and only one of them is currently tracked.
I-22	Per-owner V5 and override series as recorded observations, back to #06 and Account Rollup A3	PPC Lead to #06 owner and Data Operations	Quarterly	Calibration loses the operator dimension, so a scenario missing its predictions cannot be separated from an operator misreading it, which is precisely the separation rule-level accuracy was built to make.
I-23	Certification and recertification dates, into the above-weekly calendar	PPC Lead to #40 owner	On #40 publication, then per its calendar	Standing condition at this version, since #40 is not built. P11 step 7 runs the reviews on the cadence v4.0 rule V4 already sets and the ritual hands over on publication. Recorded as a dependency, not as a lapse.
I-24	The matrix-row request: a certification row added to the Authority Matrix so this component's decisions have a D holder of record	PPC Lead to #3 owner, CEO deciding	At the matrix's next re-issue	This SOP keeps running against rows it borrows rather than rows it holds, so Section 11.1 has to state that this SOP is I on six of eight rows. The Gap Register requires the record to be wired into the matrix; the wiring is a matrix edit and only this handoff produces it.

12.4 The gaps this section owes, stated rather than filled

Item	What it is and why no number appears in this document
AM-1	The certification pass mark. The Gap Register charter for this component names "the established pass bar" from the LTSF rollout precedent. The LTSF Master Decision and Operations System is not held in this corpus, per Ledger conflict C6, so the bar cannot be read here, and v4.0 carries no certification threshold of any kind. The per-competence demonstrated or not-demonstrated record is complete and auditable without one, which is why this document is deliverable while the item is open. Routes to the threshold owner as a v4.1 candidate.
AM-2	Maximum allowed lag from trigger to procedure start. The Build Kit depth standard asks each trigger to name one; v4.0 contains no interface-lag or process-lag threshold. Section 2 states cadence facts from named sources instead. This is the same gap SOP-12 v2.1 recorded in its own contract rules, which suggests it is a corpus-level item rather than a component-level one.
AM-3	Recertification interval. No interval exists in v4.0. P11 step 7 runs the standing reviews on the monthly and quarterly cadence v4.0 Section 14 rule V4 already sets for override review and confidence calibration, and hands the ritual to #40 on publication.

Item	What it is and why no number appears in this document
AM-4	Certification record states sit outside the closed vocabulary. The seven states in Section 5.1 are record states of this document's own artifact and write no K9 cell, but they are a controlled vocabulary the canon does not contain. The Ledger already carries the identical finding for #46's access-state vocabulary, so this logs as the second instance of one pattern rather than as a new class.
AM-5	The verdict-count discrepancy, restated because this component is the one that tests it. v4.0 Section 13.1 "The Closed Verdict Vocabulary" opens by stating the vocabulary is eighteen actions and lists eighteen. The Keyword Decision Record Template v3.0 sheet "Bands & Verdicts Reference" lists twenty-five, and SOP-12 v2.0 and v2.1 map "the full 25-verdict closed vocabulary". Master PPC Data Architecture v1.0 block K9 specifies a 26-value closed vocabulary, and the Command Workbook REFERENCE tab heads its validation column "KW VERDICT (26)" above a list of twenty-five entries. The Ledger already logs this as the 18/25/26 discrepancy on the row for #46. It is restated here because a comprehension check must test one vocabulary and a certification issued against the wrong one is a certification in the wrong system. Until it resolves, Section 5.2 quotes the KDR Template list, which is the source the operating SOPs map against, and the count used is recorded on every certification file so the pin is visible when the reconciliation lands.
AM-6	A matrix row for this component. Not a v4.0 item and not written here. Routed to #3 as interface I-24, because a decision class with no matrix row has no D holder of record and this SOP currently borrows eight rows it does not hold.

Appendix A. The certification record schema

Field	Content
Identity	Candidate role, assigning role, checkpoint holder role per component, substituted holder and the rule invoked where standing rule 5 applied.
Scope	The scope statement copied verbatim from the Transition Brief v1.2 stack, plus the target component numbers.
Version pins	Three, mandatory: component version per target component, Authority Matrix version, Criteria System version. Ledger version is recorded alongside as the boundary pin.
Gate results	Reading order per item, done or not done. Arithmetic gate per case, correct or not correct, with the variant and its expected value. Instrument gate per read, demonstrated or not demonstrated, with the artifact.
Competence table	One row per competence: ID, source matrix row, checkpoint week, mark, evidence artifact, reviewing role, date. No aggregate row exists on this table by design.
Defense record	Every question, its source, its mark, and one sentence per not-demonstrated answer stating what was missing.
Record state and history	Current state from Section 5.1 with its date, and the full state history including cleared suspensions.
Routing log	Three routings on issuance, each with a date: matrix tier assignment, access, conversion queue.
Open items	Named gaps with their re-test dates; blocked gates with the interface ID and the counterparty; the vocabulary count in force.

Appendix B. The reading-order card

Compressed from P2 for the candidate's use; the SOP text governs.

1. Register and Map: what the components are, which layer answers which question. 2. Doctrine: why the rules are what they are, before any threshold is met. 3. Criteria System, in stack order: gates, objectives, diagnosis, scenarios, levers, sizing, transitions, precedence, justification, verification. 4. Data Architecture and the Command Workbook READ ME: where each number physically lives, T0 down to T4, with T5 to T7 as the memory. 5. The assigned SOPs in wave order, each read against its Ledger row rather than on its own account. 6. Two standing habits from day one: read the manifest before the account, and score last cycle before reading this one. 7. One standing refusal: a number the system does not carry is an amendment request, never a value typed into a record.